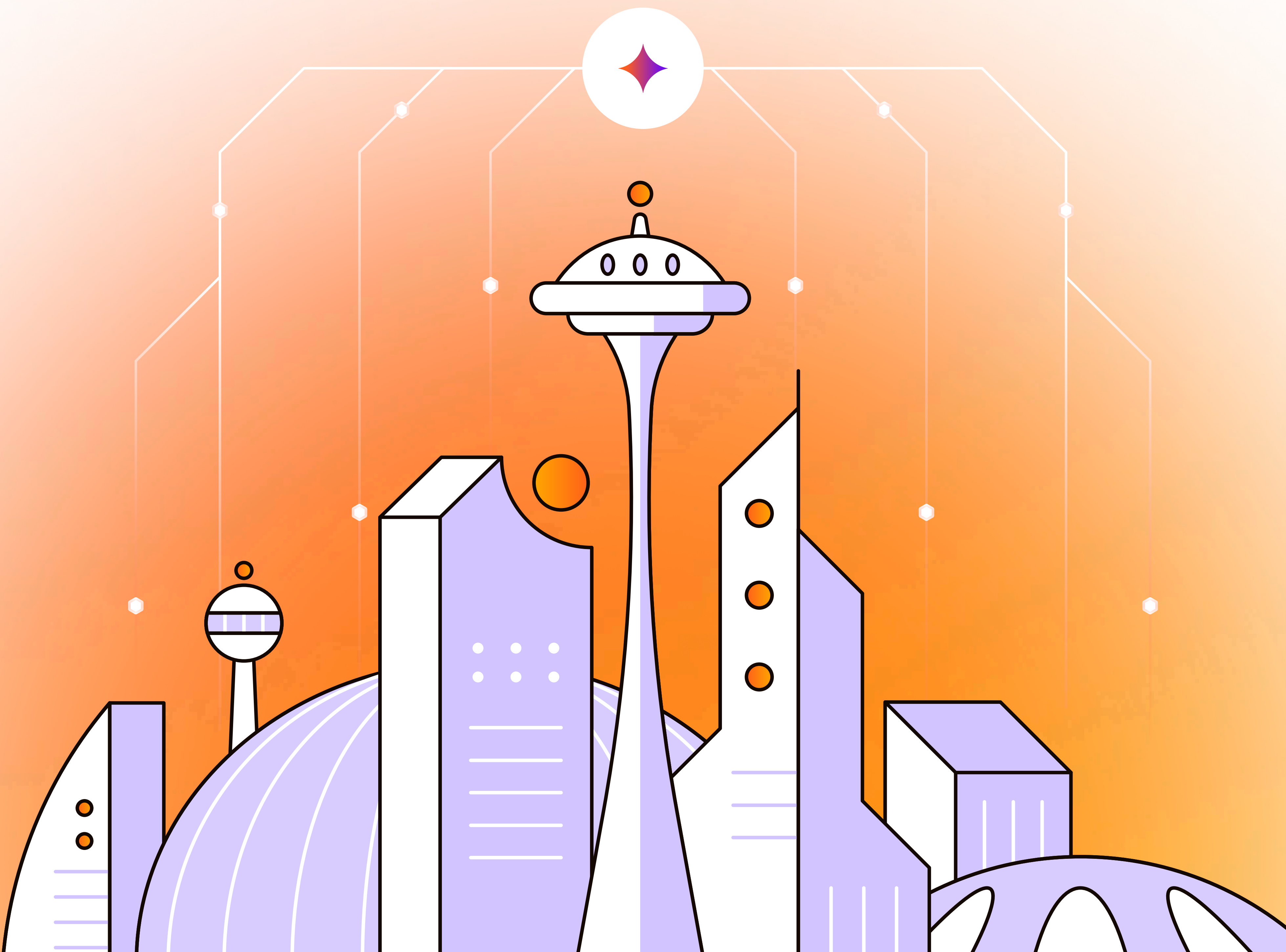




The 90-day AI Readiness Playbook

Your 30-60-90 for building AI-ready APIs





AI is changing how software is built, consumed, and connected. Your APIs are either part of this fundamental shift or an obstacle to it.

LLMs and AI agents are used increasingly to perform complex tasks. But here's the catch: these systems don't rely on tribal knowledge, intuition, or trial-and-error like human developers do. They rely on structured metadata, predictable patterns, and machine-readable documentation. If your API lacks these, your AI simply won't function.

Ensuring your APIs are both human and machine readable can be a daunting task, requiring improvements to compatibility, consistency, and compliance. While these challenges introduce workflow fragmentation that slows competitors down, they present a strategic opportunity for you to leap ahead.

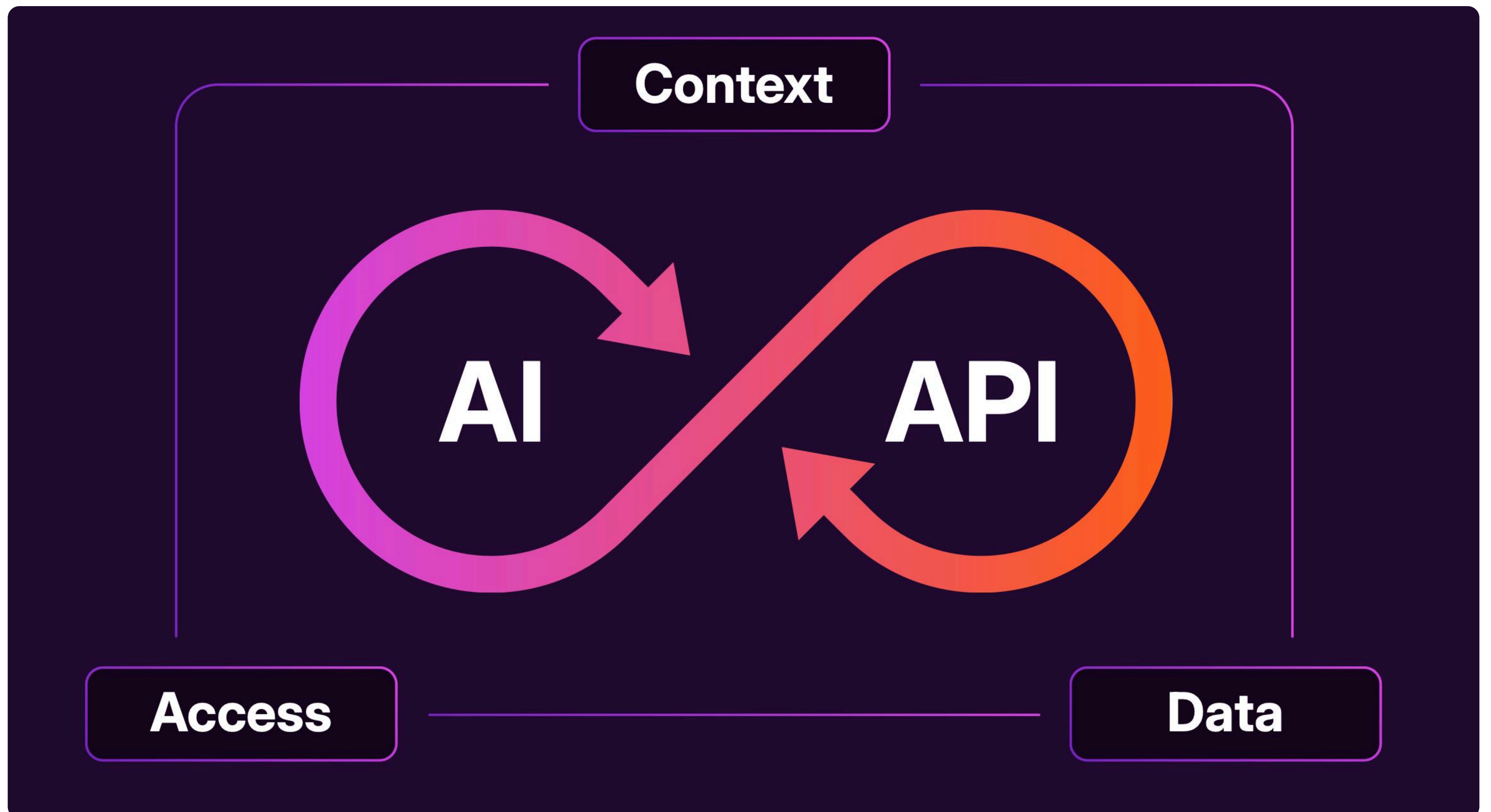
This playbook provides a 90-day plan to get your APIs AI-ready, empowering you to accelerate innovation and lay the foundation for an AI-driven future.

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By the way, we've also prepared a [Developer's Guide to AI-Ready APIs](#). Think of it as an API checklist and toolkit your developers can use to tackle what's outlined here, one step at a time.

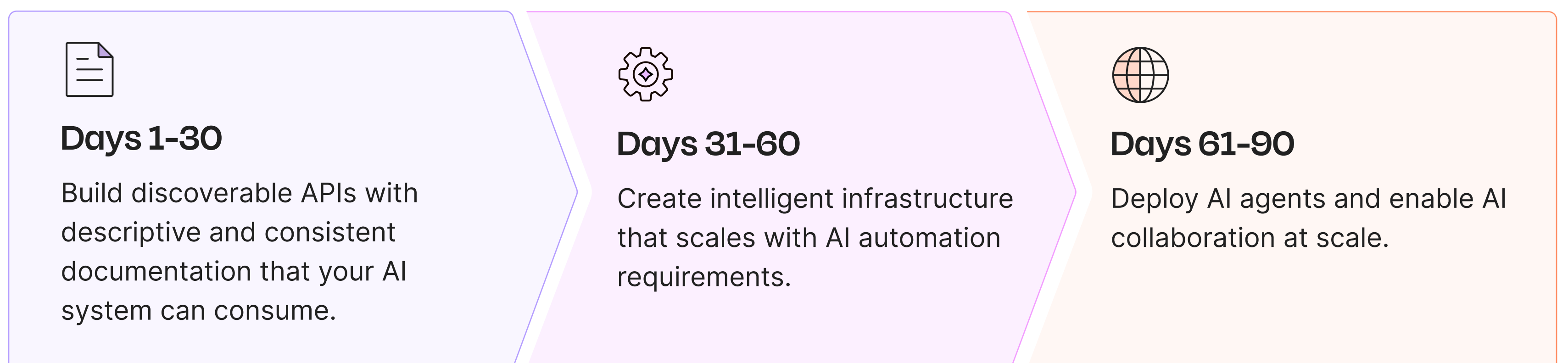
The reality of preparing for AI

The concept is simple, but the execution may not be so obvious. In reality, AI agents can't navigate fragmented documentation spread across multiple tools. Machine learning models need consistent, reliable data interfaces that poorly governed APIs can't provide. Not to mention, intelligent automation breaks down when APIs lack standardization and visibility.



The organizations getting ahead with AI aren't just better at LLMs—they've solved scalable API collaboration at their organizations first.

Here's a glimpse at what your 90 days will look like:



Let's get into it.



First 30 days: Build AI-ready foundations

AI agents can't work without clear instructions and descriptions. Unlike humans, they don't troubleshoot. They simply stop working and report an error.

Here's an example of metadata that works for humans but not for machines:

```
"This endpoint accepts a user ID and returns user preferences"
```

The AI-ready version below provides explicit semantic meaning through operationIds, detailed descriptions, parameter types, and schema references. It leaves nothing to interpretation or prior knowledge.

```
paths:
  /users/{userId}/preferences:
    get:
      parameters:
        - name: userId
          in: path
          required: true
          schema:
            type: string
      responses:
        200:
          description: User preferences retrieved successfully
          content:
            application/json:
              schema:
                $ref: '#/components/schemas/UserPreferences'
        404:
          description: User not found
        500:
          description: Internal server error
    components:
      schemas:
        UserPreferences:
          type: object
          properties:
            theme:
              type: string
              example: "dark"
            notifications:
              type: boolean
              example: true
```

So, before implementing intelligent automation, you need clean, discoverable APIs with consistent documentation. Month one focuses on eliminating the collaboration friction that blocks AI adoption.

Week 1 Assess and Audit

Understanding your current state is critical before building AI-ready infrastructure. Most organizations underestimate how fragmented their API landscape has become and how these gaps create systematic barriers to AI integration.

In this phase, you'll map your complete API landscape including where documentation lives, how they are discovered, and their specifications. Pay special attention to identifying which APIs have machine-readable documentation versus human-only documentation, as AI systems require structured, consistent formats. Be sure to assess current collaboration workflows and monitor how long it takes new developers to discover and use existing APIs.



 According to the 2024 State of API Report, **58% of developers rely on internal documentation to learn APIs.**

Week 1 key activities:

-  Inventory all production APIs and their current documentation state with Agent Mode
-  Map collaboration workflows and identify handoff friction points with API Governance
-  Establish baseline metrics for API discovery with Postman's API Network (PAN) and monitor development cycles

 **Week 1 outcome:** Clear understanding of gaps that prevent AI integration.

Week 2 Unify Team Collaboration

Teams working in isolation can't support AI initiatives that require coordinated integration across multiple systems. To resolve this, deploy unified workspaces with Postman Collections—where teams can collaborate instead of work individually. Postman's enhanced workspace capabilities include improved notifications and commenting systems that keep teams connected throughout development.

Migrate individual collections to shared environments and establish naming conventions for consistency. Set up collaborative workflows with review processes that maintain quality while enabling rapid iteration.

Week 2 key activities:

-  Deploy collaborative workspaces for each development team
-  Migrate individual API work to shared, team-accessible environments
-  Establish collaboration workflows and naming conventions

 **Week 2 outcome:** Teams actively collaborate in unified environments instead of working in isolation.

Week 3 Standardize for AI Consumption

As mentioned, AI systems require consistent, machine-readable documentation to function effectively. Implement organization-wide API documentation standards that ensure consistency and create specifications that AI systems can consume. Postman's Spec Hub provides developer-friendly API design and governance capabilities that streamline this standardization process.



You'll need to deploy automated documentation generation and validation to ensure specifications stay current, but if you're using Spec Hub, documentation generation is automatic. Once your documentation is generated, you'll need to ensure it's discoverable. Postman's **API network** capabilities include discovery features that help teams find and reuse existing APIs. Not to mention, Postman's PAN is the largest API database, featuring 100K+ APIs discoverable with AI.

Week 3 key activities:

- ✓ Implement consistent, machine-readable documentation standards
- ✓ Deploy automated documentation generation and validation with Spec Hub
- ✓ Add AI-consumable metadata and tags to API specifications
- ✓ Publish the APIs to PAN to increase visibility

★ **Week 3 outcome: All APIs have consistent, machine-readable documentation that AI systems can consume.**

Week 4

Implement Quality Gates

Quality gates prevent inconsistencies and security gaps that make AI integration unreliable. Establish minimum documentation requirements and automated quality checks that validate API specifications against actual behavior.

Postman's Bring Your Own Key (BYOK) Encryption capabilities ensure that governance and security standards can scale without compromising data protection.

Implement feedback loops that connect development, testing, and documentation workflows. These quality gates create the foundation needed for Postman's **AI Agent Builder** capabilities that become essential in later phases.

Week 4 key activities:

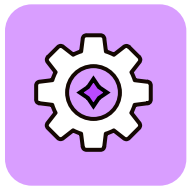
- ✓ Define and implement minimum API documentation requirements
- ✓ Deploy automated quality validation in development workflows
- ✓ Establish metrics and alerts for API quality standards

★ **Week 4 outcome: Quality gates ensure only well-documented, AI-ready APIs reach production.**



At the end of 30 days...

By the end of month one, you'll have clean, discoverable APIs with consistent documentation that AI systems can actually consume and understand, teams will collaborate efficiently instead of working in isolation, and quality gates will prevent the chaos that makes AI integration impossible.



Days 31-60: Create intelligent infrastructure

Month one established clean APIs and team collaboration. Month two builds the technical infrastructure that AI systems specifically require, such as real-time data pipelines, automated workflows, and intelligent monitoring that can support AI agents and automation at scale.

Week 5

Build AI-Ready Data Pipelines

AI systems require real-time access to current data through reliable, high-performance APIs. That means traditional request-response patterns often aren't sufficient for AI workloads that need streaming data, batch processing, and complex data transformations.

 AI-related traffic across the Postman platform has **increased by nearly 73% in 2024**.

Week 5 key activities:

 Implement API orchestration capabilities that can chain multiple APIs together for AI consumption using Postman Flows

 Set up real-time data streaming endpoints that AI systems can monitor for changes

 Create batch processing APIs for ML training and inference workloads

 **Week 5 outcome: High-performance data pipelines optimized for AI consumption patterns.**

Week 6

Deploy Intelligent API Automation

AI allows business to build intelligent workflows that are capable of responding to context and data. APIs are the backbone of intelligent workflows, allowing you to automate workflows that can handle complex business logic, make decisions based on data patterns, and integrate with machine learning systems.

Week 6 key activities:

 Build workflow automation using Postman Flows that can orchestrate multi-step processes across different APIs and systems

 Implement intelligent request routing and load balancing

 Create automated error handling and recovery systems that maintain reliability for AI workloads

 **Week 6 outcome: Intelligent automation infrastructure that supports complex AI workflows.**



Week 7 Implement AI-Specific Monitoring

AI systems generate different usage patterns and performance requirements than humans. You'll need to deploy monitoring and analytics specifically designed to track AI workload performance, data quality, and system health.

Week 7 key activities:

- ✓ Implement real-time performance monitoring with Postman Insights that can detect patterns relevant to AI systems
- ✓ Set up data quality monitoring that ensures APIs provide consistent, reliable data for machine learning systems
- ✓ Create alerting systems that can proactively identify issues before they impact AI performance
- ★ **Week 7 outcome: Comprehensive monitoring infrastructure optimized for AI system requirements.**

Week 8 Enable Autonomous API Management

AI systems benefit from infrastructure that can self-optimize and adapt to changing conditions. Implement autonomous management capabilities that can scale resources, optimize performance, and maintain security without manual intervention.

Week 8 key activities:

- ✓ Deploy auto-scaling infrastructure that can handle variable AI workloads
- ✓ Implement intelligent caching and optimization that adapts to usage patterns
- ✓ Create security automation that can detect and respond to threats in real time while maintaining AI system performance
- ★ **Week 8 outcome: Autonomous infrastructure that self-optimizes for AI performance and security.**

At the end of 60 days...

By the end of month two, you'll have technical infrastructure specifically designed for AI systems: real-time data pipelines, intelligent automation, AI-optimized monitoring, and autonomous management capabilities. Your APIs can now support the complex, always-on requirements of AI agents and automation.



Days 61-90: Enable AI collaboration at scale

Month two built intelligent infrastructure. Month three deploys AI agents, implements intelligent automation, and enables the AI-powered collaboration that transforms how your organization builds and operates APIs. This is where your 90-day investment really pays off.

Week 9

Deploy AI Agents and Automation

With clean APIs and intelligent infrastructure in place, you can now deploy AI agents that actually work reliably. The foundation you've built now enables AI agents to consume your APIs as structured tools through function calling capabilities.

i Learn how to create agent-ready MCP servers with Postman's [MCP server generation tool](#).

Week 9 key activities:

- ✔ Generate and deploy MCP-compatible tool definitions from your API specifications, enabling AI agents to understand and invoke your APIs as structured functions with clear parameters and expected responses
 - ✔ Use Postman's AI Agent Builder to create intelligent agents that can discover APIs, execute complex workflows, and make autonomous decisions based on real-time data through standardized tool calling interfaces
 - ✔ Build AI agents that can automatically test new APIs, validate documentation accuracy, and identify optimization opportunities by leveraging the tool calling infrastructure to programmatically interact with your API ecosystem
 - ✔ Implement tool calling validation and monitoring to ensure AI agents are invoking functions correctly and handling responses appropriately
- ★ **Week 9 outcome: AI agents actively managing routine API operations and optimization through reliable, structured tool calling mechanisms that bridge your APIs and AI systems.**

Week 10

Integrate with AI/ML Systems

Now that you have AI agents managing routine tasks, integrate your APIs with actual AI and machine learning systems. As you connect with multiple AI providers, establishing evaluation frameworks becomes critical for ensuring optimal performance and reliability.



Week 10 key activities:

- ✓ Connect your APIs to LLMs like GPT, Claude, or Gemini for intelligent data processing
 - ✓ Implement LLM evaluation frameworks using tools like [Postman's LLM Model Evaluation templates](#) to compare performance, accuracy, and cost across different AI providers when powering your AI agents and workflows
 - ✓ Build workflows that combine your business APIs with AI services to create intelligent applications that can reason about your data and make autonomous decisions
 - ✓ Establish benchmarking and testing protocols to continuously evaluate which LLM models work best for specific API-driven tasks and use cases
- ★ **Week 10 outcome:** APIs successfully integrated with external AI/ML systems for intelligent business applications, with robust evaluation frameworks ensuring you're using the optimal AI models for each workflow.

Week 11

Deploy AI-Powered Business Workflows

Use Postman's AI Agent Builder to create intelligent business workflows that combine multiple APIs with AI reasoning.

Week 11 key activities:

- ✓ **Build agents** that can process customer inquiries, analyze business data, and make recommendations by orchestrating calls across your API ecosystem
 - ✓ Create AI workflows that can adapt to changing business conditions and optimize themselves based on the latest data
- ★ **Week 11 outcome:** Intelligent business workflows operating autonomously across your API ecosystem.

Week 12

Enable AI Ecosystem Partnerships with MCP

Extend AI capabilities beyond your organization by creating AI-powered integrations with partners and vendors using the Model Context Protocol (MCP). MCP streamlines the building of AI applications by standardizing how they connect to tools, making well-documented, publisher-maintained APIs more critical than ever.



Week 12 key activities:



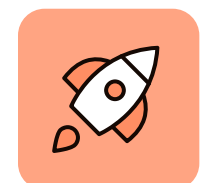
Build **MCP servers** that provide standardized interfaces for AI applications to communicate with your APIs and orchestrate complex tasks



Create specialized MCP servers tailored to specific use cases rather than connecting to multiple disparate APIs, since LLMs perform better with a focused set of tools



Establish verified, reliable MCP servers that developers can test and integrate with directly, ensuring accuracy and maintainability



At the end of 90 days...

By the end of month three, your APIs are no longer just internal tools—they're intelligent interfaces that power AI-driven business applications through standardized protocols like MCP. You've successfully integrated with external AI systems, deployed autonomous business workflows that adapt and optimize themselves, and created MCP-enabled partnerships that provide reliable, discoverable interfaces for AI applications.

You're ready to take on AI

In 90 days, you've built what most organizations will spend years trying to achieve: intelligent infrastructure that makes AI adoption not only possible but scalable.

While others attempt AI projects on chaotic foundations, you now have AI agents managing operations, predictive systems preventing problems, and intelligent automation accelerating development across your entire ecosystem.

Your APIs are no longer just endpoints—they're instructions for intelligent action.



For more resources on how to make your APIs AI-ready, check out our [AI resource center](#).